# Spatial Cognition or Pattern Matching?

**Re-examining CityGPT (Feng et al.)** — KDD 2025

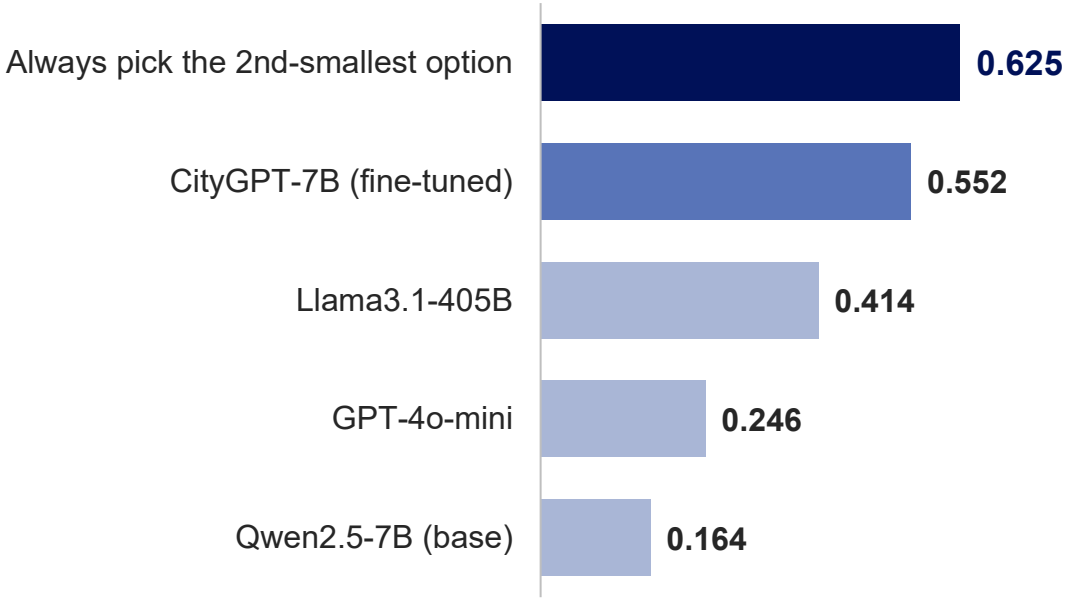
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# Spatial cognition or pattern matching?

## Spatial reasoning accuracy on CityEval, Beijing




Scores: Feng et al., CityGPT (KDD '25), Table 1. Rule: expected score on the released CityEval v2.3; picks the 2nd-smallest distance (3rd for POI-to-POI), guesses direction.

## What I add

1 **Retrain**
my own CityGPT-style model
(no checkpoints are released)

2 **Break the shortcut**
fair options, no options, fictional places, unseen cities

3 **Fix the data**
retrain without the pattern and measure the gain that survives

## Did it learn the city, or the test?

# Thank you for your attention



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